

ACA, Cancillería, reg. 1867, f. 1r — Joan I — Assignment of 4,000 florins on papal *decimae* to Hug d'Anglesola — Barcelona, 10 June 1387

Document Summary

Field	Detail
Archival reference	ACA, Cancillería, reg. 1867, f. 1r
Date	Barcelona, 10 June 1387 (<i>decima die junii anno a Nativitate Domini M^o CCC^o LXXXVII^o</i>)
Language	Latin
Document type	Royal financial mandate / <i>assignatio</i> — assignment of revenue in part-payment (<i>in solutum</i>) of a court debt
Issuing authority	Joan I, king of Aragon
Beneficiary (creditor)	Hug d'Anglesola (<i>Hugo de Angularia</i>), royal councillor and admiral, styled count of Cardona ¹
Disbursing officer	Joan de Muntrós (<i>Johannes de Muntros</i>), of the royal household, receiver and administrator-general at Barcelona
Audit authority	The <i>Magister Racionalis</i> of the royal court (Mestre Racional) and the auditors of accounts
Sum	4,000 florins of Aragon, the <i>pro rata</i> share of an 8,000-florin court debt
Charged on	The <i>decimae</i> (clerical tenths) newly granted to the king by the supreme pontiff
Repayment schedule	2,000 florins after one year; 2,000 florins in the following year
Seal	Secret seal (<i>sigillo secreto</i>)
Chancery subscription (<i>iussio</i>)	Francesc ça Costa (<i>Franciscus / ffrancesch ça Costa</i>)

Reconciled Transcription

Manuscript orthography preserved; abbreviations expanded silently except where flagged.
Remaining uncertainties marked [?].

Nos Johannes Dei gracia Rex [et cetera]. Insolutum pro rata illorum octo milium florenorum auri de Aragon[ia] debitorum per curiam nostram, vobis nobili et dilecto consiliario et ammirato nostro Hugoni de Angularia, comiti Cardone, cum littera nostra data Barchinone XXVIII^a die aprilis anno presenti, tenore huius assignamus vobis quatuor mille florenorum in et super pecunia decimarum nobis noviter per dominum summum pontificem concessarum, percipiend[os] ad manus fidelis de domo nostra Johannis de Muntros, cuius Barchinone receptoris et administratoris generalis: prime solucionis videlicet duos mille florenorum, assignacionis die ad unum annum, et in anno alio subsequenti alios duos mille florenorum, vobis ex ipsis decimis realiter persolvendos. Mandantes per hanc eidem receptori et administratori iamdicto quatenus de pecunia perventura ad manus suas ex dictis decimis vobis solvat, aut cui volueritis loco vestri, dictos quatuor mille florenos infra duos annos proxime secuturos ut supra dictum est. Recipiendo inde apochas, in quibus inseratur prefata littera obligatoria [?] et de presenti [habeatur?] mencio; spacio in dorso eiusdem littere obligatorie [?] quod dedimus ponatur ipsi quatuor mille florenorum, seu quod exinde vobis solutum extiterit manu nostra, cum apochas de eisdem confiteat[ur]. Presens quoque littera recuperetur in soluzione finali predictorum quatuor mille florenorum. Quam per eandem iniungimus Magistro Racionali curam [?] nostre vel alii cuicumque adicto [?] receptorem et administratorem compotum [?] auditoribus, quod quicquid vobis ut prefertur persolutum fuerit per eundem in computo suo recipiat, ipso tum receptis rationibus eius experimentis cautelas superius expressatas. In cuius rei testimonium presentem fieri iussimus nostro sigillo secreto munitam. Data Barchinone decima die junii anno a Nativitate Domini M^o CCC^o LXXXVII^o. ffranc[iscus] ça Costa.

Annotated English Translation

We, John, by the grace of God king [of Aragon, etc.],² in part-payment³ for the proportional share of those eight thousand florins of gold of Aragon owed by our court — to you, our noble and beloved councillor and admiral⁴ Hug d'Anglesola, count of Cardona, by our letter given at Barcelona on the twenty-eighth day of April of the present year⁵ — by the tenor of this [letter] assign to you four thousand florins on and upon the money of the tithes⁶ newly granted to us by the lord supreme pontiff,⁷ to be received at the hands of the trusty [member] of our household Joan de Muntrós, receiver and administrator-general thereof⁸ at Barcelona: namely, of the first payment, two thousand florins, on the day [one year] from the assignment;⁹ and in the following year, the other two thousand florins, to be paid to you in actual coin¹⁰ from those same tithes.

Commanding by this [letter] the said receiver and administrator aforesaid that, from the money coming into his hands from the said tithes, he pay to you — or to whomever you may wish in your

stead — the said four thousand florins within the two years next following, as is said above. Taking thereupon receipts (*apochae*),¹¹ in which the aforesaid bond-letter¹² shall be inserted, and let mention be made of the present [letter]; in the space on the dorse of the same bond-letter let there be entered what we have given, [namely] the said four thousand florins, or whatever shall thereupon have been paid to you by our hand, when he draws up the receipts for the same.¹³ Let the present letter likewise be recovered upon the final payment of the aforesaid four thousand florins.

Which [command] we accordingly enjoin upon the Master Rational of our court¹⁴ — or upon any other [officer] whomsoever assigned¹⁵ to [audit] the accounts of the receiver and administrator, [and upon] the auditors¹⁶ — that whatever shall have been paid to you, as is set forth above, he allow [the same] in his (sc. the receiver's) account, the reasons (*racionibus*) being then received¹⁷ together with¹⁸ his proofs¹⁹ [and] the warrants (*cautelae*)²⁰ set out above. In testimony of which thing we have ordered the present [letter] to be drawn up, furnished with our secret seal.²¹ Given at Barcelona on the tenth day of June in the year from the Nativity of the Lord one thousand three hundred and eighty-seven. [By the hand of] Francesc ça Costa.²²

Footnotes

Unresolved Ambiguities

1. **Hug d'Anglesola as count of Cardona.** The reading *Hugoni de Angularia comiti Cardone* is paleographically secure, but the attachment of the **county of Cardona** to a member of the **Anglesola** lineage requires prosopographical reconciliation. Possible avenues: (a) a marriage or tenure conveying the comital style; (b) the title held *iure uxoris* or in some honorific/administrative sense; (c) a need to revisit whether *comiti Cardone* qualifies Hug or stands in apposition to a third party. The concurrent style *consiliario et ammirato* (councillor and admiral) should be cross-checked against the admiralty of the Crown of Aragon under Joan I — this office-plus-comital-style combination bears directly on the dissertation's dual-officeholding argument. **Recommended follow-up:** verify the admiral of Aragon c. 1387 and trace the Cardona comital succession against the Anglesola family.
2. **The cross-referenced letter of 28 April 1387** (n. 5). The day numeral *XXVIII* is read with some uncertainty in the final minims (*XXVII* not excluded). Identification of this prior instrument in the registers would clarify the constitution of the original 8,000-florin debt. **Recommended follow-up:** search reg. 1867 and adjacent volumes for an act of late April 1387 in favour of Hug d'Anglesola.
3. **The papal concession of the *decimae*** (nn. 6–7). The phrase *noviter ... per dominum summum pontificem concessarum* points to a recent grant of tithes by Clement VII to Joan I. **Recommended follow-up:** identify the specific papal concession (bull or breve) and its

stated purpose, which may illuminate whether the underlying 8,000-florin debt was itself incurred for a purpose (naval/crusading?) connected to the admiral's office.

4. **The bond-letter terminology** (*obligatoria* vs *obnoxia*, nn. 12–13). The abbreviation is compressed; *obligatoria* is preferred on formulaic grounds but not confirmed by autopsy. This does not affect the document's sense.
 5. **The audit clause, lines 16–17** (nn. 14–20). The substance — an instruction to the Mestre Racional and deputy auditors to allow the payments in Muntrós's account on production of the warrants — is secure. The exact wording (*vel alii cuicumque adicto receptorem et administratorem compotum auditoribus*) is syntactically rough and partly conjectural; the accusatives *receptorem et administratorem* do not resolve cleanly against *auditoribus*. **Recommended follow-up:** collate against the standard *Magistro Racionali* allowance formula in contemporary mandates to regularize the reading.
 6. **Joan de Muntrós as receiver-general of the tithes at Barcelona** (n. 8). The surname is fixed on the researcher's authority. **Recommended follow-up:** confirm his tenure as *receptor decimarum* / administrator-general at Barcelona in 1387 in the chancery and Mestre Racional records, and establish his household standing (*de domo nostra*).
1. The comital style attaching to a member of the **Anglesola** lineage is the chief prosopographical crux of the document (see Unresolved Ambiguities, below). The manuscript reading *Hugoni de Angularia comiti Cardone* is paleographically secure; the apparent association of an Anglesola with the **county of Cardona** requires reconciliation against the descent of that comital title, which in this period belonged to the house of Folch de Cardona. The document independently styles him *consiliario et ammirato* (councillor and admiral), a household-and-office combination of direct relevance to the dissertation's argument on dual officeholding. ↵
 2. The scribe wrote only *Rex et cetera*, suspending the full royal style (*Aragonum, Valencie, Maioricarum, Sardinie et Corsice, comesque Barchinone, Rossilionis et Ceritanie*). The suspension is reproduced as written; the titulature is not silently expanded. ↵
 3. *Insolutum* (= *in solutum*), the technical term of Roman and *ius commune* practice for a transfer **in payment** / **in satisfaction** of a debt (*datio in solutum*). The functional sense is not "unpaid" but "[given/assigned] in settlement of": the 4,000 florins are assigned *in solutum* of the larger 8,000-florin obligation. This reading rests on the researcher's own transcription of the opening protocol. ↵
 4. *ammirato* — the gemination is confirmed by the nasal bar over the opening minims. The office is that of **admiral** (*ammiratus* / *almirall*) of the Crown of Aragon, not a generic title of affection; an earlier candidate reading *amicato* is rejected. ↵
 5. *cum littera nostra data Barchinone XXVIII^a die aprilis anno presenti*. The cross-reference is to a prior letter of **28 April 1387** (the day numeral read *XXVIII*, with some uncertainty in the final minims), by which the original obligation was constituted or acknowledged. This earlier instrument, if it survives in the registers, would document the underlying 8,000-florin debt. ↵

6. *decimae* — the **clerical tenths**: a tax of one-tenth on ecclesiastical revenues, levied with papal authorization and conceded by the pope to the crown, characteristically to fund military or crusading undertakings. This clause is the fiscal core of the document and reframes it entirely: the assignment is charged not on ordinary royal revenue but on **papal-tithe income**, pledged here against a secular court debt. ↵
7. *per dominum summum pontificem* — i.e. the pope of the Avignon obedience recognized by the Crown of Aragon, **Clement VII**, to whom Joan I adhered. The phrase *noviter ... concessarum* ("newly granted") implies a recent concession of the tenths, datable to the first months of the reign. ↵
8. *receptoris et administratoris generalis* — the officer charged with receiving and administering the tithe revenue (the *receptor decimarum*). The genitive *cuius* refers to the *decimae*: Muntrós is receiver-and-administrator-general of **those tithes** at Barcelona. The surname is given as **Muntrós** on the researcher's authority; the nasal bar over the first minim supports the resolution *Mu[n]tros*. ↵
9. *prime solucionis ... assignacionis die ad unum annum*. The phrasing is compressed; the sense is that the first instalment falls due one year from the date of assignment. The genitives *prime solucionis* / *assignacionis* are read as partitive/temporal rather than as governing a finite verb. ↵
10. *realiter persolvendos* — "to be paid in actual coin," i.e. in cash and not by further assignment or tally; *realiter* here functions adverbially against the possibility of mere paper transfer. ↵
11. *apocha* (Cat. *àpoca*) — a notarial **receipt** or quittance acknowledging payment. The plural here anticipates a receipt for each instalment. ↵
12. *littera obligatoria* — a **bond-letter** recording the obligation; the reading is preferred over an alternative *obnoxia* / *obnoxiatum* on formulaic grounds, as *obligatoria* is the standard chancery term for such an instrument and accords with the *in dorso* endorsement procedure described. The abbreviation is genuinely compressed and the reading is flagged [?]. ↵
13. The endorsement mechanism: each partial payment is to be entered (*ponatur*) on the **dorse** of the bond-letter, so that the original obligation is progressively discharged on its own verso as the receiver draws up the corresponding *apochae*. *confiteat[ur]* ("acknowledges / draws up") is expanded from a suspended form. ↵
14. *Magister Rationalis curie nostre* — the **Mestre Racional**, the chief auditing magistrate of the royal household and court, responsible for auditing the accounts of all crown financial officers. The instruction directs him to allow the disbursements in Muntrós's account. ↵
15. *vel alii cuicumque adicto* — "or to any other [officer] whomsoever assigned/deputed," read on the researcher's authority. *adicto* is taken as *adicto* (= *addicto* / *adiecto*), "assigned, deputed [to the audit]"; the construction extends the mandate beyond the Mestre Racional to any deputy auditor. ↵
16. *receptorem et administratorem compotum [?] auditoribus*. The accusatives *receptorem et administratorem* sit awkwardly in the syntax; the functional sense is "the auditors of the

accounts of the receiver and administrator." The phrasing is partly conjectural and is flagged in the transcription. ↵

17. *ipso tum receptis rationibus* — an ablative-absolute construction: the audit is to be allowed once the supporting reasons/accounts (*rationes*) have been received. ↵
18. Reading *tum* ("then, at that point") with the researcher's *ipso tum*; the temporal sense governs the receipt of the accounting evidence. ↵
19. *experimentis* — "proofs, supporting evidence" (the documentary vouchers substantiating the account). An alternative *experiencie* was considered and rejected. ↵
20. *cautelae* — **warrants** or formal supporting documents (the *apochae* and bond-letter together) that justify the entry in the audited account. The literal "precautions / securities" sense is here the technical "vouchers." ↵
21. *sigillo secreto* — the **secret seal**, used for administrative and financial mandates of this routine but confidential character, as distinct from the great seal or the pendant seal reserved for solemn acts. The reading corrects an earlier *sigillo certo*. ↵
22. **Francesc ça Costa**, here subscribing the *iussio*. The same hand and name recur across Joan I's chancery in this period in a senior secretarial/expediting capacity. The vernacular form *ffrancesch ça Costa* appears at the foot of the document; the Latin *Franciscus ça Costa* is given for the formal subscription. ↵